ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Every book is a collaboration, and this one more than others. There is much to be said about quantum mechanics, and there was definitely a temptation to say it all. That might have been a fun book to write but it would have been a tedious chore to read. I owe a variety of generous and insightful readers for their help in wrestling the manuscript down to something manageable and, hopefully, in parts, fun. I should specifically mention helpful comments from Nick Aceves, Dean Buonomano, Joseph Clark, Don Howard, Jens Jäger, Gia Mora, Jason Pollack, Daniel Ranard, Rob Reid, Grant Remmen, Alex Rosenberg, Landon Ross, Chip Sebens, Matt Strassler, and David Wallace. In ways stretching from small—offhandedly mentioning something in conversation that later ended up in the book—to large—reading every chapter and offering useful insights—these generous folks helped rescue me from writing a book that would not have been nearly as good.

I want to give special thanks to Scott Aaronson, who is the best test-reader a physicist/author could ask for, giving the text a thorough reading and offering invariably useful feedback on both substance and style. I'll also mention Gia Mora again, because she was inexplicably omitted from the acknowledgments of *The Big Picture*, and I feel bad about that.

It goes without saying that I've learned an enormous amount about quantum mechanics and spacetime from a large number of extremely smart people over the years, and their influence pervades this book even if I didn't talk specifically about the words written here. Many thanks go to David Albert, Ning Bao, Jeff Barrett, Charles Bennett, Adam Becker, Kim Boddy,